YOU WILL MAKE IT

7 BOLLYWOOD CELEBRITIES WHO FOUGHT MENTAL DISORDERS

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YOU WILL MAKE IT

7 Bollywood Celebrities who fought mental disorders

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DEDICATED TO

Every soul who is struggling to defeat mental issues

BECAUSE YOU MATTER.

CONTENTS

1. Why this book? 4
2. Deepika Padukone 6
3. Shah Rukh Khan 9
4. Anushka Sharma 12
5. Honey Singh 14
6. Ileana D'Cruz 17
7. Sanjay Dutt 20
8. Manisha Koirala 22
9. About the Author 24
10. References 25

1. WHY THIS BOOK?

STIGMA OF MENTAL HEALTH

What's your first reaction when you get to know that someone has a brain disorder? Do you get seriously and horrified? Well, that's because here in our country, most of us yet don't recognize the brain to be a part of the physical body. Just like any hand or leg injury, we can have some mental health related issues.

IS EVERYONE PRONE TO MENTAL DISORDERS?

Whether we are rich or poor, we have anxieties, and we seek purpose for life. It is very usual for everyone to be prone to such issues. There are variances in vulnerability due to genetics, our upbringing and our environment.

AIM OF THIS BOOK

The sole purpose of writing this book is to reach every youth of the country who is willing to give up because of depression or any disorder, and help them believe that he/she can create a better future for himself/herself, just like the celebrities we are going to talk about did.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK?

The chapters have been divided into sub-sections in order to make it interesting for the reader. When you read this book, you would realize that the worst situations can also turn into a beautiful future.

Binay Bhattacharya

Founder and CEO, **MakeMyBrain**

2. DEEPIKA PADUKONE

For years we've been made to feel we should be okay with settling for less. But you should get what you think you deserve. It's okay to fight for it.

- Deepika Padukone

AN UNUSUAL CRY

Deepika's parents had come all way from Bangalore to Mumbai to stay with her. It was the time when Deepika was busy in the shooting of the movie 'Piku'. One day, Deepika went to her mom and bursted into tears. Her mom noticed that it was an unusual cry. She could sense a crave for help in that cry.

Deepika had always stayed strong in front of her parents. May it be on call or in person, she puts a smile on her face in order to make them feel assured that everything is going well. But this time, she couldn't stop herself.

Her mom could sense the symptoms of depression and ask for help from her psychiatrist friend, Anna Chandy.

"DIDN'T FEEL LIKE LIVING ANYMORE"

Media criticized her when she revealed about her depression. "She is already earning so much as a film star. What does she want now?

Doesn't make sense for her to be depressed." She felt a lack of purpose in her daily life. She didn't feel like meeting anyone or going anywhere.

Deepika explains that she used to get an unusual feeling in her stomach, a feeling of emptiness. During mornings, she didn't want to wake up because she felt that emptiness eating her inside. She had gradually started losing her desire to live.

DEEPIKA'S RECOVERY

Deepika had to take medications and therapies. She gradually made changes in her lifestyle, as she believes that mental health is something you need to take care of forever. She could overcome her depression.

Deepika talks to several people who have overcome depression or are suffering from it, and learns from them.

LESSONS TO LEARN

It is believed that a person who has mental illness is weak. Because of this, many people don't reveal about their conditions, fearing that the society would see them as weak individuals. We need to realize that seeking help while having a mental illness is the strongest step a person can take.

It is important to take care of our mental health forever, because our mental health also impacts our physical health. So the greatest takeaway from Deepika's story is to stop being afraid of others' opinions and fight for yourself.

My choices are like my fingerprints, they make me unique.

- Deepika Padukone

3. SHAH RUKH KHAN

Everything you need is already inside you. Don't wait for others to light your fire. You have your own matches.

- Shah Rukh Khan

BEGINNING OF DEPRESSION

During the shooting of a film, a painful incident happened to Shah Rukh – his shoulder muscle got torn. That pain and inability to work gradually started impacting his mental health. Shah Rukh Khan went through a phase of depression thereafter. Eventually, he took off again after healing from his injury.

In a conversation with IANS, Shah Rukh Khan said, "I feel so much healthy and refreshed from within – due to the injury and suffering I got into a depression mode, but now I am out of it. I feel happy and boosted with energy."

SHAH RUKH'S NATURE

Shah Rukh Khan discloses that he is shy in nature and often finds it difficult to express his emotions of joy, sorrow, love, anger, hatred… Due to this, people often judge him and criticize his words. The audience has a very different image of SRK through movies, where

he is too charming and highly expressive. But of course, despite his shyness, he brings life to any movie through his acting.

THE ATTITUDE OF KING KHAN

Several times, SRK has been compared with other actors. His movies are often criticized and compared with other movies. One reason behind this is that SRK has set a really high standard for himself. He has been wrongly compared to people ahead of him like Mr. Bachchan, and also with the young artists. SRK is adamant at creating his own path and walking alone. There was a time when he was an ordinary boy running behind his dream. He used to stand by the sea and shout that he would someday be the king of Bollywood. And thus, SRK maintains his legacy.

Kehte hain, agar kisi cheez ko dil se chaho, to poori kayenaat use tumse milaane ki koshish me lag jaati hai.

- Dialogue from 'Om Shanti Om'

LESSONS TO LEARN

We can learn a lot from SRK's attitude. Believing in yourself and sticking to your dream despite of hardships and failures would help you find out your true potential. Even after facing situations of criticism and comparison, SRK stays mentally strong and keeps working hard to uplift his level.

Another important thing we could learn is that physical and mental health affect each other. If we get an injury, it would lead to

disturbance in our mental state as well. Similarly, if we stay in a negative state for a long time, our body shrinks and we also face many more physical problems.

Whatever you do in life, just do it like it's your first and last time, and you'll never get another chance.

- Shah Rukh Khan

4. ANUSHKA SHARMA

My biggest fear is fear itself. I never want to be afraid of doing something I want.

- Anushka Sharma

"WHY DON'T WE TALK OPENLY ABOUT IT?"

Anushka has been suffering from anxiety disorder, and is on medication for it. She believes that there is nothing to hide about your mental health conditions. When there is pain in your stomach, you go to the doctor. Just like that, if you face mental pain, just go to the doctor!

Anushka wants to make it her mission to take away the stigma of mental health and educate people about it.

WHAT IS ANXIETY DISORDER?

Anxiety disorder refers to prolonged periods of anxiety and stress, mostly thinking negatively about the future. The person having anxiety disorder often gets panic attacks and gets stressed easily.

DOES FAMILY HISTORY PLAY A ROLE?

Anushka revealed that she has seen many cases of depression in her family, so it is quite obvious that she would be more prone to it. And that's true. Genetics play a role in mental health to some extent.

Anushka works in Bollywood, which is an ultra-competitive environment. Thousands of new actors emerge everyday, and you can become jobless anytime. A movie needs a good script, direction, acting and music… everything together to become a hit. So being in such an environment, it is very natural for anyone to fall prey of anxiety. It's inspiring how Anushka tackles her disorder and keeps moving ahead.

LESSONS TO LEARN

If you think too much about the future, that could lead to anxiety. I know it is good to be future-oriented, but that's true in terms of what actions we want to take. If you are constantly thinking about the outcomes, may it be positive or negative, you will start developing stress and anxiety out of it.

Ignorance is bliss. But being aware and not getting affected by what people say is bravery.

- Anushka Sharma

5. HONEY SINGH

Every revolutionary poet or lyricist has been criticized for something.

- Honey Singh

THE ERA OF YO YO HONEY SINGH

Hirdesh Singh, professionally known as *Yo Yo Honey Singh*, has been a very successful songwriter, composer and rapper. Who hasn't heard his superhit rap songs that moved the whole country in the early 2010s. Nearly every hit movie of Bollywood of that era comprised of a song of Honey Singh, which could slay down your bad mood, and make you feel good and energetic.

THE DARK PHASE

As mentioned earlier, Bollywood is a highly competitive field. Gradually Honey Singh faced many rejections and failures, which ultimately led to depression. He took almost 3-4 months to realize that he is not well. The once superstar had fallen prey of alcoholism due to his depression. But he never stopped fighting, and created the song 'Dheere Dheere' for Hritik Roshan's movie, which turned out to be a very popular song.

WE NEED PEOPLE FOR SUPPORT

Honey Singh's family helped him and supported him while this depressive phase of his life. Along with that, Shah Rukh Khan and Deepika Padukone also supported him to fight his battle with depression.

Eventually, after nearly two and a half years, Honey Singh was back, and revealed about the horrifying phase of his life. He also said that if someone has mental issues, it is really important for him/her to disclose it, so that people can support during that phase.

LESSONS TO LEARN

This chapter on Honey Singh teaches us two important lessons. The first one is that whatever level we reach in our life, we will surely face depressive phases in our career. So, whenever that happens, accept that and take actions to make your condition better.

The second and the most important lesson is to make valuable relationships with trustworthy people who would be ready to help you in your tough times.

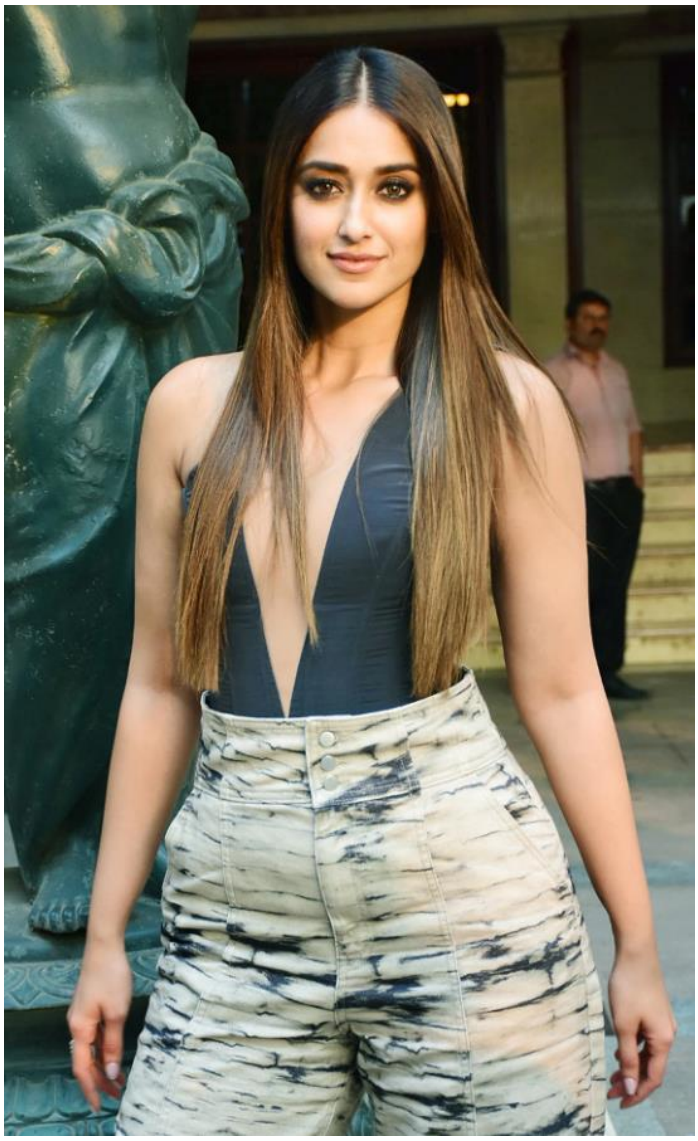
First they eat from your hand, then they bite you. But they can not touch the lion inside you.

- Honey Singh

6. ILEANA D'CRUZ

Love yourself, and trust me, if you are happy within, you are the most beautiful.

- Ileana D'Cruz



WHAT IS BODY DYSMORPHIC DISORDER?

In this disorder, the person becomes too much conscious of his/her physical appearance, and gets too much anxious about the flaws in body.

"I THOUGHT OF COMMITTING SUICIDE"

Ileana has been with this disorder since her early days. With time, it had started getting severe. Her intense anxiety lead here to think that committing suicide is the only solution to escape imperfection. Ultimately, after taking therapies, she realized that nothing is perfect in the world. Whatever we do, there would still be some imperfections

left. After that, she gained confidence to love herself, how-so-ever imperfect that tiny bump or scar looks.

This is not only the problem with Ileana, but many others. Seeing movies leads us to imagine everything to be perfect. And when we come back to reality, we find contradiction.

A MESSAGE BY ILEANA

"Imperfections are a part of life and one should learn to love who you are. You are a human being and are allowed to be imperfect, and you are allowed to be flawed. There is a lot of beauty in your imperfections, in your uniqueness," Ileana said.

Ileana adds that you were never meant to be perfect. You are meant to be beautifully flawed. Different. Quirky. Unique. Every scar, every bump, every 'flaw' just makes you, you. Your own kind of beautiful…

LESSONS TO LEARN

To every girl who is anxious about her stretch marks… to every boy who is worried about his complexion… to everyone who is stressed out because of his/her scars and marks… Ileana would be a good example for you. Being in the Bollywood industry, she now happily accepts the flaws in her body and sets an example.

The first part of healing yourself is being aware that there is something wrong.

- Ileana D'Cruz

7. SANJAY DUTT

In life, luck also favours the one who has the passion for winning.

- Sanjay Dutt

DEPRESSION AND DRUG ADDICTION

He may have played and aced the role of Doctor Munna Bhai on screen, but this actor suffered from insomnia and depression during his prison stay. The untimely demise of his mother and legal hassles followed by marital problems led to this state until he took the initiative to recover and get back to a normal way of living.

Sanjay Dutt has been very vocal about his struggle with drug addiction. His addiction problem started when he was in college. "It was just the 'in' thing at that time. Somebody just said try it and that was it," he once said in an interview.

Sanjay himself admitted having tried every drug in the book, ranging from LSD to weed to painkillers. He even talked about his hallucinations while under the influence of psychedelic drugs. However, after nine years of drug addiction, Sanjay Dutt decided to come clean and sober and went into rehab. For the last four

decades, he has been sober and a true example and inspiration for millions of youth reeling under the deluge of substance abuse and looking for an addiction-free life.

LESSONS TO LEARN

Sanjay Dutt is a great inspiration for people who are into addiction and substance abuse. He is a true example of someone who has seen both the sides of life.

Your fate is erased when you die, but maybe it will change if you stay alive.

- Sanjay Dutt

8. MANISHA KOIRALA

Stop chasing what your mind wants, and you will get what your soul need.

- Manisha Koirala

BATTLING WITH CANCER AND DEPRESSION

We choose to live our life in some way, but that doesn't always happen. Life is too uncertain. Fighting cancer, Manisha realized many intricacies of life, which she wrote down in her book 'Healing'. Along with cancer, she was suffering from depression.

MANISHA'S PHILOSOPHY

During an interview she had said, "How slowly, shadows of my past friendships are becoming distant dream… did I have bunch of friends with whom there were promises of life time? Disappointed, yes I'm…but then life fills you with new hope, new friends…hoping this time round it would be rooted in deep values rather than just crazy, fun times!!"

The 'Dil Se' actress did open up about what she has learnt from her trials in life. She said, "Normally, what we have dreamt of doesn't happen and what we haven't imagined takes place. We should try

to do the best we can in that situation. We should take that surprising situation like a learning lesson, something which can enhance our life."

LESSONS TO LEARN

An important lesson to learn from Manisha's experience is that if your attitude is right, you will learn something even in the toughest phase of your life. Moreover, a big problem among youngsters at this stage is changes in friendships. And that's completely okay. Changes are meant happen in every aspect of life. What we can do is to accept the changes and adapt accordingly.

I think cancer came into my life as a gift. My vision is sharper, my mind clearer, my perspective realigned.

- Manisha Koirala

9. ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Okay, time to know me. I am Binay Bhattacharya, and I am a constant learner. Presently I run the healthcare startup called MakeMyBrain (MakeMyBrain.com) where we connect psychologists and patients online.

Talking about my education, I completed my primary and secondary education from Chinmaya Vidyalaya, Bokaro (Jharkhand). I secured AIR 3666 in JEE Advanced 2020 and got admission in the B.Tech course of Chemical Engineering at IIT Kharagpur. While I am writing this book, I am entering into the third year of my college studies.

I always wanted to help the youth to tackle depression and addiction related problems and thus, I saw this as an opportunity to make something valuable.

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